

industry's bright spots. As Ashwin Jain, Assistant Manager, Gaming System Business Group- ASUS India puts it, "There has been a plenty of improvement over the time in the Indian gaming industry, with the amount of spectators increasing day-by-day. The newest trend in the market that goes as "virtual reality" guarantees a bright future for the gaming industry in India."

FOR INDIAN GAMERS, WITH LOVE

As the number of tournaments and prize money stacks up, the gaming gear is not to be left behind. Different companies are entering the fray to introduce new machines that are jumping the popularity bandwagon among Indian gamers.

Recently, ASUS announced new products for its flagship range, Republic of Gamers (ROG). There is a high end gaming laptop, two desktops, an ultra-portable and two mainstream laptops. Acer also announced the launch of its Predator 15 and 17 gaming notebooks in India. The new gaming notebooks are powered by Intel's sixth generation Core i7 processor.

These companies, each of which traces its origin to Taiwan - a hub for the Information and Communication Technology (ICT) industry - are looking at India with renewed hope. Says Panigrahi, "The gaming industry in India is a hot bed of opportunities. India is amongst the top 20 countries that are set to grow in this space by 2020. The key areas where the country has the right potential is perhaps hardware industry where an increasing number of gamers are interested in buying specialized gaming hardware be it PC or a console."

With Indian gamers showing a zeal for the field like never before, companies are giving out their best. Acer, for example has introduced many innovative features on their Predator gaming line-up which is closely collaborated with gamers. Features like FrostCore for high performance cooling, SoundPound for immersive sound, VR

ready devices, AeroBlade fan with dust defending technology to name a few are helping to push the performance of gaming devices.

Like Acer, MSI too has some great offerings for the Indian market. In August, MSI completely revamped its gaming lineup, introducing the latest GeForce GTX 1060, GeForce GTX 1070, and GeForce GTX 1080 graphic cards for its GT series, GS series, and GE series of laptops. The lineup names also adds "VR" to mostly all the laptops, thanks to the new VR-ready nature of the Nvidia GPUs. While the company sponsors several gaming platforms internationally and was the official sponsor for the Taiwan Excellence Gaming Cup this year, it has many more ambitious plans for India. Said Rhyen Sy, MSI South Asia Notebook Sales Executive, "It is true that the gaming industry in India is in a nascent stage and will take a little time to match up with South East Asian countries. But we see such a huge potential for gaming in India that it has prompted us to become more pro-active when it comes to initiatives for the industry in India."

SILVER LINING

While companies are upbeat about their offerings, it is said that high import duty on gaming products has often acted as a spoiler resulting in excessive prices, sometimes making games unaffordable for the average Indian consumer. But companies are undeterred. Says Rhyen, "Yes high-end gaming products are expensive in India but gaming lovers don't hesitate to buy these products. With the coming of GST, prices of these products can further increase, but the demand is still there."

They have their solutions too as Rhyen from MSI points out that the Taiwan Government is working with the Indian government to develop software and hardware technology. Panigrahi too adds that the company encourages the government to help provide support for the gaming industry as it has the potential to open up this fledgling industry.

